of conflict between them. Many had hatred towards the neighboring kingdoms and animosity had eaten into each society. A civil war was inevitable.

The three kingdoms had differing views of monarchy and state. James I had a lot of power and freedom to do as he wished when he was the King of Scotland. He was able to command the Scottish parliament and ruled with little criticism. James was restricted heavily when he took the English throne and the new rules significantly limited his powers. He had limited access to the treasury, which upset him greatly. Known as an extravagant king, James was constantly short of funds and became frustrated by Parliament's refusal to give in to his demands.

Furthermore, the three kingdoms had a different dominant religion. The English were predominantly Protestant, the Scottish were Calvinist and the Irish were primarily Catholic. There were also a number of influential religious minorities within each kingdom that further complicated this precarious melting pot of faith.

Before becoming the King of England and Ireland, James had promised to adopt a tolerant stance on religion by stating that he would not persecute anyone unless they broke the law. However, James did not keep his promise. He persecuted the English Catholics when he became king just as severely as he had done before. In 1605, disillusioned by James' false promises and determined to be heard, a group of Catholic conspirators orchestrated the famous Gunpowder Plot. The conspirators were led by man named Robert Catesby who had planned to blow up the Houses of Parliament with King James inside. Evidence of gunpowder and matches was found before they could carry out the bombing. The authorities eventually discovered the plotters and Catesby was killed during a gun battle. The plot ended up being a failure and Catesby's head was set on a spike outside the House of Parliament as a reminder to anyone who plotted against the king.

Despite the dramatic events of 1605, James' reign was a time of relative peace across the three kingdoms. James had done his best to keep his